

XIANG (CHARLIE) CHENG

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Robert H. Smith School of Business
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Research Interests

Topics Applications and Economics of Generative Artificial Intelligence
Methods Analytical Modeling, Causal Inference, Deep Reinforcement Learning, Experiment

Education

2024– University of Maryland – College Park, MD
Ph.D. in Information Systems
2020–2024 Renmin University of China – Beijing, China
Bachelor of Business Administration, Financial Management
Fall 2023 New York University – New York, NY
Visiting Student

Research and Publications

Papers under Review

- W1. Xiang Cheng and Manmohan Aseri. **Incentive Issues in Developing Factual LLMs.** [\[Paper Link\]](#)
 - Under 3rd Round Review at *Information Systems Research*
 - UMD Faculty-Student Research Award
- W2. Xiang Cheng, Raveesh Mayya, and João Sedoc. **To Err Is Human; To Annotate, SILICON? Toward Robust Reproducibility in LLM Annotation.** [\[Paper Link\]](#)
 - Major Revision at *Management Science*
- W3. Xiang Cheng and Manmohan Aseri. **Breaking AI Collusion with Consumer AI.** [\[Paper Link\]](#)
 - Major Revision at *Management Science*
- W4. Xiang Cheng, Wen Wang, and Anindya Ghose. **LLMs for Explainable Business Decision-Making: A Reinforcement Learning Fine-Tuning Approach.** [\[Paper Link\]](#)
 - Under review at *Information Systems Research*
- W5. Xiang Cheng and Wen Wang. **(How) Can LLMs Enhance Privacy Research?** [\[Paper Link\]](#)
 - Under review at *Information Systems Research*

Work-in-progress

- W6. Xiang Cheng, Manmohan Aseri, Siva Viswanathan, and Esther Gal-Or. **The Economics of LLM-Publisher Partnerships.**
 - Modeling in progress

W7. Xiang Cheng, Eaman Jahani, and Siva Viswanathan. **Metacognitive AI and Peer Information in Collective Decisions.**

- Large-scale experiment in progress
- Smith Internal Research Grant (2025, 2026)

Conference Proceedings

- P1. Xiang Cheng and Wen Wang, (How) Can LLMs Enhance Privacy Research? (2025). ICIS 2025 Proceedings. 33. [\[Link\]](#)

Honors and Scholarships

- 2026 Smith Internal Research Grant, UMD, \$17,000
- 2025 Faculty-Student Research Award, UMD, \$15,000
- 2025 Smith Internal Research Grant, UMD, \$10,000
- 2024 International Conference Student Support Award, UMD, \$400
- 2024–2029 Graduate Assistantship and Summer Fellowship, UMD
- 2022 Undergraduate Student Innovative Research Project, RUC, CNY 20,000
- 2021–2023 Jingdong Scholarship/First Class for Academic Excellence (Top 1%), RUC, CNY 5,000 – 8,000

Teaching experience

- Fall 2026 BMGT 302: Essential Programming and AI Skills for Business Analytics
 - Instructor
- Fall 2026 MBA AI Bootcamp
 - Guest instructor for two sessions, each taught in person and online
 - Topics: agentic AI for case analysis and vibe coding for business applications
- Fall 2026 BMGT 398I: Individual Study in Business and Management, Emerging Topics I
 - Guest instructor for two sessions

Presentations and Talks

[†] denotes presented by coauthor; [‡] denotes an invited talk.

Xiang Cheng, Eaman Jahani, and Siva Viswanathan. **Metacognitive AI and Peer Information in Collective Decisions**

- Workshop on Information Systems & Economics (WISE), Lisbon, Portugal (Dec 2026)
- Conference on Digital Experimentation (CODE@MIT), Cambridge, MA (Nov 2026)
- Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST), San Francisco, CA (Oct 2026)
- Workshop on AI and the Future of Collaborative Innovation (WAICI), New York, NY (Oct 2026)
- The 14th ACM Collective Intelligence Conference (CI 2026), Alexandria, VA (Sep 2026)

Xiang Cheng and Manmohan Aseri. **Breaking AI Collusion with Consumer AI**

- Fisher AI in Business Conference, Columbus, OH (Oct 2026)
- Workshop on AI and the Future of Collaborative Innovation (WAICI), New York, NY (Oct 2026)
- POMS Annual Conference, Reno, NV (May 2026)^{† ‡}

- Biz AI Conference at The University of Texas at Dallas (BizAI), Dallas, TX (Mar 2026)[†]
- Conference on AI, ML, and Business Analytics (AI/ML), New York, NY (Dec 2025)[†]

Xiang Cheng, Wen Wang, and Anindya Ghose. **LLMs for Explainable Business Decision-Making: A Reinforcement Learning Fine-Tuning Approach**

- Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST), Atlanta, GA (Oct 2025)
- INFORMS Workshop on Data Science 2025, Atlanta, GA (Oct 2025)

Xiang Cheng and Wen Wang. **(How) Can LLMs Enhance Privacy Research?**

- International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS), Nashville, TN (Dec 2025)
- INFORMS Workshop on Data Science 2025, Atlanta, GA (Oct 2025)
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Atlanta, GA (Oct 2025)[‡]
- AI Lightning Talks at UMD Smith School (Oct 2025)[‡]

Xiang Cheng and Manmohan Aseri. **Incentive Issues in Developing Factual LLMs**

- Workshop on Information Technologies and Systems (WITS), Nashville, TN (Dec 2025)
- AI and the Future of Work Conference at Wharton, Philadelphia, PA (May 2025)[†]
- Biz AI Conference at The University of Texas at Dallas (BizAI), Dallas, TX (Mar 2025)[†]

Xiang Cheng, Raveesh Mayya, and João Sedoc. **To Err Is Human; To Annotate, SILICON? Toward Robust Reproducibility in LLM Annotation**

- Biz AI Conference at The University of Texas at Dallas (BizAI), Dallas, TX (Mar 2026)[†]
- Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE), Nashville, TN (Dec 2025)[†]
- Conference on AI, ML, and Business Analytics (AI/ML), New York, NY (Dec 2025)
- Conference on Information Systems and Technology (CIST), Atlanta, GA (Oct 2025)
- Business & Generative AI Conference at Wharton, San Francisco, CA (Sep 2025)[†]
- Workshop on AI and the Future of Collaborative Innovation (WAICI), New York, NY (Sep 2025)
- Symposium on Statistical Challenges in eCommerce Research (SCECR), Paphos, Cyprus (Jun 2025)[†]
- Biz AI Conference at The University of Texas at Dallas (BizAI), Dallas, TX (Mar 2025)
- Workshop on Information Technologies and Systems (WITS), Bangkok, Thailand (Dec 2024)

Xiang Cheng, Raveesh Mayya, Lanfei Shi, and Shun Ye. **Support or Setback? Unpacking the Impact of the Small Business Badge**

- Workshop on Information Systems and Economics (WISE), Bangkok, Thailand (Dec 2024)

Academic Service

Journal Reviewer

2025– Information Systems Research

Conference Reviewer

2025-2026 Workshop on Information Technologies and Systems (WITS)
2025–2026 International Conference on Information Systems (ICIS)
2024 Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS)